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Institute of Health Policy, Management and Evaluation
UNIVERSITY OF TORONTO

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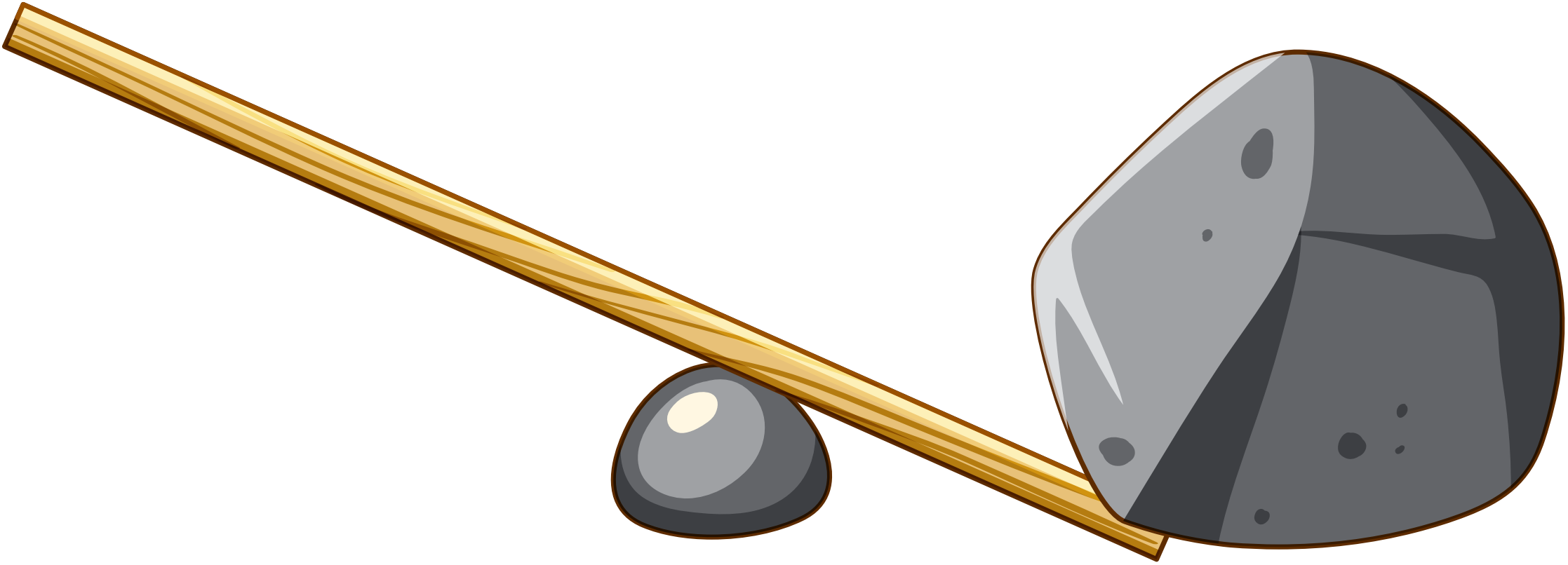
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SCALING AND DIMENSIONALITY

Why might you need to be careful with variables of **different scales** (e.g., income in thousands and age in years) when clustering public health data with K-means?

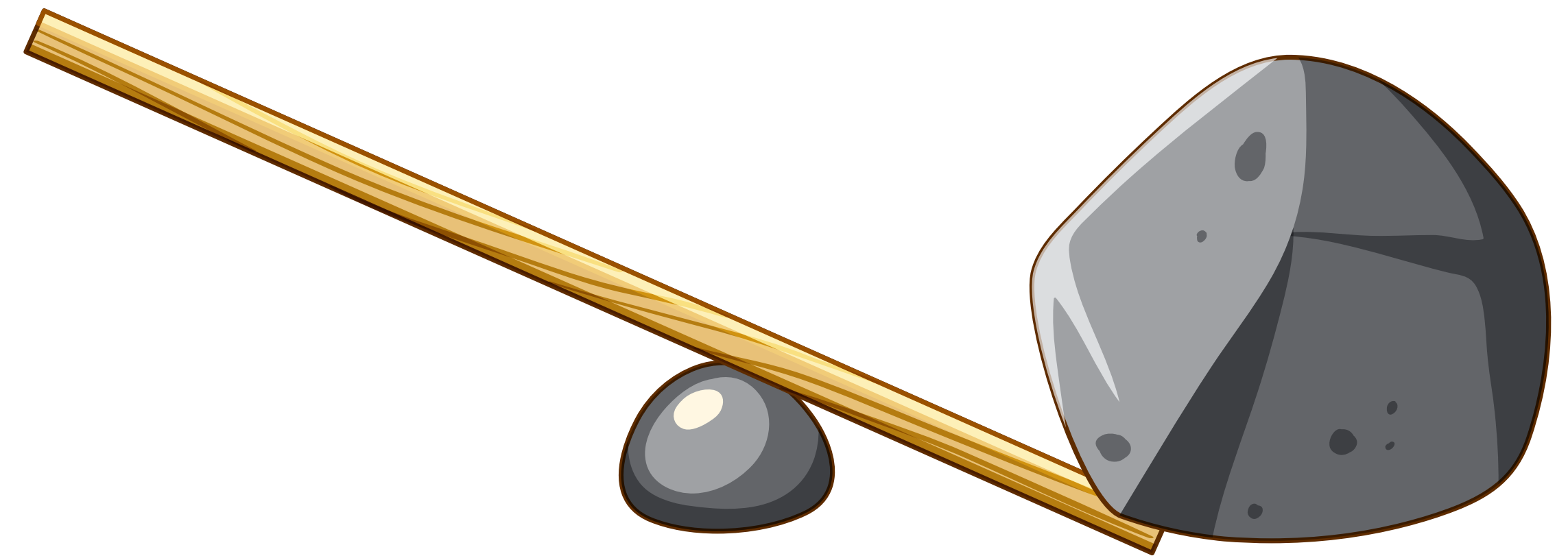
***“Answer:** K-means uses distances, so features with larger scales can dominate the clustering process. It's essential to normalize or standardize data to ensure each feature contributes equally to the distance computation.”*



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APPLIED MACHINE LEARNING FOR HEALTH DATA–LECTURE #2

NEIGHBOURHOODS (KNN) AND GROUPING (K-MEANS)

Instructor: Zahra Shakeri

University of Toronto

Fall 2023

